

Chapter 7

Simplify Your Environment

Welcome to part 3: “Don’t Go Broke.”

By now, you’re getting familiar with your values, spending behaviors, and some of the sub-skills that will help you improve your spending. And if it’s taken you more than a day to get to this part, you’ve probably already started identifying some purchases you feel good about and some you don’t. It’s here in part 3 that we’re giving you the principles you need to stick with the process.

While going broke can happen a lot more quickly than getting rich, neither happens overnight. The lifestyle you choose to embrace, the people you surround yourself with, and the mindset you adhere to each play a major role in whether you choose values-aligned spending decisions or impulsive ones.

The key to sticking with values-based spending long-term is embracing how your brain works. We’re all prone to try to go all-in on good changes, but sometimes what looks good is unrealistic. We can say “no more impulse buys” all day, but our brains crave instant gratification, and the moment we have a stressful day, our brain forgets what it wants and goes for what it needs in the moment: dopamine. Now that we know how our brains work thanks to the last section, we can talk about how we can use our knowledge to our advantage to keep up beneficial money practices long-term. Or, hopefully, just long enough for values-based spending to become second nature.